Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick
Fourth Sunday of Easter – Vocations Sunday - Year A – 26th April 2026

Parish Clergy
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Thoughts on the Gospel

John's Gospel is sometimes referred to as the 'spiritual Gospel,' as it has beautiful, reflective passages. During the Easter season, we read and hear mostly from John. It is a lovely opportunity to meditate more deeply on the Word. Today, we are given the image of Jesus as the Shepherd and of his people as the flock. We hear the words 'I know them.' Jesus knows each person intimately. He knows our deepest desires, our worries and fears, our insecurities and pain. Jesus is as close to us as our own breathing. Nobody can interfere with this intimate friendship, even though at times we may feel differently. We may experience discrimination because of our faith, or be attacked in some way. When things are not going so well, we may feel as if Jesus has abandoned us; sometimes we simply want to give up on the whole thing. We become distant. Let this passage be a reminder to us that Jesus is always very close to us and knows our struggles. We simply need to share those struggles and fears with Him, for 'no one will snatch them [you] out of my hand.' We may forget this from time to time. This week, can you spend five minutes each day meditating on this passage? Focus on the breath. A phrase to repeat might be: 'Jesus, I know that you are as close to me as my own breathing.'

Vocations Sunday Today, the Fourth Sunday of Easter or Good Shepherd Sunday is a special day for everyone in our parish. We celebrate the World Day of Prayer for Vocations. We ask that we may be filled with joy and the Holy Spirit as we carry on the mission of Jesus, our Good Shepherd. Let us pray for one another that we may be strengthened in our Christian vocations as married and single people, priests, deacons and religious. May our young people listen to God's call and be encouraged to respond generously. Visit https://derryvocations.org/

Diocesan Prayer for Vocations God our Father, you call us by name, and ask us to follow you. Help us to grow in the love and service of your Church today. Grant us the courage to embrace Christ's mission of love and justice. Bless the Church here in the Diocese of Derry by raising up generous and dedicated leaders from among our families and friends, who will serve your people as priests, sisters, brothers, deacons and lay ministers. Bless those who have already answered your call and who are now preparing for service in your Church. Inspire us to know you better, and open our hearts and minds to the guidance of your Holy Spirit. We ask this through Christ our Lord. Amen.

Rosary At The Grotto, Porthall will take place on Friday 15th May at 7.00 pm, led by Fr McCaughey. All parishioners are invited to attend.

The Parish Draw will take place on Thursday 30th April at 7.30 pm in the Parochial House, Ballymagorry. Good luck to all those entered. If you have not yet paid your ticket for April you can do so at the Pastoral Office.

Sick and Housebound Fr McCaughey plans to visit sick and housebound in the coming days:
Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday: Camus and Leckpatrick
Thursday: Murlog. We pray for all who are sick and housebound at this time.

Requiescant in Pace We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of
John Devine (Mór), Slieveboy Rd, Claudy
Martin Moohan, Conthem Road, Bearney, Strabane
Tony McLaughlin, formerly Rathbeg Drive, Limavady / Glenmornan

Anniversaries Lawrence O'Kane, Damien Friel, Joseph Ferguson, Rose Dunne, Willie McAleer, Anne McNulty-Gallagher, Pat Cooke, Brian Wood, Annie Clarke, Patsy Quinn, Josephine Boyle, Daniel McKane, Christine McKane, Julie McSorley, Declan McGinnis, Fionnuala Boyle, Molly Hannigan, Hugh James Doherty, Paddy McCullagh, David Horwood, Danny Diver, Grace Coyle, John McGill, Hugh McGarrigle, John Elliott, Billy Coups, Julia McCloskey, Jimmy McBride, Gerry McNamee, William McLaughlin, Kay Campbell, Celine Holland, Jimmy McBride, Veronica Coyle. May they rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections:
Leckpatrick: £1,638.20
Clonleigh: €2,180.47
Camus: £1,652.35.
Thanks to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 3rd May:
First Reading: Acts 6: 1-7
Psalm: 33: 1-2, 4-5,18-19
Second Reading: First Peter 2: 4-9
Gospel: John 14: 1-12

Saints of the Coming Week:
Monday: St Asicus, bishop
Tuesday: St Louis Grignion de Montfort, priest; St Peter Chanel, priest and martyr
Wednesday: St Catherine of Siena, virgin and doctor of the Church
Thursday: St Pius V, pope
Friday: St Joseph the Worker
Saturday: St Athanasius, bishop and doctor of the Church

The Contemplative Prayer Group meets on Mondays at 8 pm in the Prayer Room in the Parochial House, Barrack St. All welcome.

Murlog Parish Pilgrimage To Knock Shrine *Saturday 25th July*, leaving Murlog Chapel at 7.15 am. Cost: €50 per person, (includes coach/refreshments/meal). Please contact: James: 0858767999, Mary: 0877625237 or Bernie: 078 53272541.

Parish Bingo and Lucky Four A warm welcome to all to St Patrick's Hall every Thursday at 8 pm. Come along for some fun and excitement and slight competition.

A Mass to Mark the Silver Anniversary of the Episcopal Ordination of Bishop McKeown will be celebrated today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm in St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry. We give thanks to God for Bishop McKeown's faithful service and dedicated ministry over the past twenty-five years since his Episcopal Ordination. May the Lord continue to bless him with wisdom, strength, and good health as he shepherds his people with care and compassion. Everyone is welcome.

Pray for Vocations Please keep vocations in your prayers.

Lough Derg Day Retreats (a day of guided prayer and reflection) take place on
May 3rd, 4th, 9th, 12th, 17th, 23rd, 25th,
August 18th, 22nd, 23rd, 29th, 31st,
September 5th, 6th, 9th, 12th, 15th, 19th, 20th. Adm: €50. Booking essential.

3 Day Pilgrimages in the tradition of prayer, fasting and vigil take place from May 29th - August 15th. Adm: €85. Booking advisable. Contact +353 (0) 719861518, info@loughderg.org or visit www.loughderg.org

Holy Cross College Music Department will present their Spring Concert in the College Hall on Wednesday 29th April beginning at 7 pm. Admission is free with a retiring collection at the end. The concert will feature soloists, the college orchestra, instrumental ensembles and the junior and senior choirs. All welcome.

St Eugene's Cathedral Scholars Applications open on 27th April for the 2026-2027 Choral Scholars' Scheme. Open to all full-time students over 16. The choral scholars sing with the cathedral choir weekly and at other special events. They will receive instruction in a wide range of choral music and a stipend for their participation. Entrance is by application only. For an application, please contact the director of music at maghnusmonaghan@hotmail.com Deadline 11th May 2026.

Diocesan Pilgrimage to Lough Derg - 24th - 26th July. Visit Diocese of Derry - News - Diocese of Derry Pilgrimage to Lough Derg – July 2026

Charity Coffee Morning at Strabane Golf Club – Lady Captain's Charity Coffee Morning will take place on Monday 27th April from 10.30 am - 1.00 pm. All welcome to join us for some lovely treats.

The Columban Young Adults is a new group for those aged 18 - 30 in the diocese, seeking a community of like-minded young adults who have Christ at the centre of their lives. The first event will be a talk on Thursday 30th April at 7.30 pm in Our Lady of Lourdes Church, Steelstown, Derry, delivered by the Servant Sisters of Home of the Mother. It will be on the question, 'Why be a Young Catholic in 2026?' in which they will also reflect on the life of Sr Clare Crockett. The talk will be followed by Solemn Benediction and light refreshments. Everyone welcome.

Encounter Weekend Donegal, Radisson Blu, Letterkenny. Friday 5th June 6 pm - 10.30 pm; Saturday 6th June 9 am - 10.30 pm. Experience the presence of God through the celebration of the sacraments, Spirit-led worship, inspiring talks, healing service, and fellowship. Come and be refreshed and empowered by the Holy Spirit and learn from the saints how to live the lifestyle God intended you to live. Keynote Speakers: Patrick Reis: co-founder and Executive Director of Encounter Ministries USA & Fr Patrick Gonyeau who serves with the US Province of the Missionaries of the Precious Blood in Ohio. Bookings at https://encounterschoolofministrydoneg.regfox.com/encounter-conference-donegal For more information, email donegal@encounterschool.org

Marriage Preparation Workshops take place on May 15th / 16th and June 19th / 20th 2026. To book, please visit www.accordni.com. Please note that Accord Derry will NOT be facilitating courses during July or August.

Job Opportunity: Derry Diocesan Trust - Temporary Administrative & Financial Officer (15 Hours per week), Parish of Urney & Castlefin, Co Donegal, based in the Parochial House in Doneyloop. Working Days & Times to be negotiated. Reporting to the Parish Priest, the role entails provision of administrative and financial support. For application pack, please contact: Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, BT48 9AP, tel 028 71262302 or recruitment@derrydiocese.org. Completed applications must be returned no later than **12 noon Thursday 7th May 2026.**

Men's Rosary takes place in Market Square, Letterkenny on Sat 2nd May at 1 pm.

Gamblers Anonymous Is gambling affecting your life? We would like to help. Pick up the phone and ring 028 7135 1329.

Trócaire Boxes can be returned to our churches during the week. Thank you in anticipation of your traditional generosity to this very worthy Lenten appeal.

Diocesan Youth Pilgrimage to Fatima Those aged 16+ are invited on pilgrimage to Fatima from 3rd - 8th August. A unique experience for young people and an opportunity to engage with their peers from around the world in a faith context.
Cost: £820. Please contact bethany.doherty@derrydiocese.org / 028 71264087.

Rosary on the Coast takes place on Sunday 3rd May at 3 pm at Lisfannon Beach, praying for peace, Ireland and our unborn children. Everyone welcome.

Donegal Pro Life is inviting support to attend the March for Life in Dublin on Bank Holiday Monday, 4th May. For details / to book the sponsored bus contact: Margaret on 089 2469599 or Teresa on 086 2647235 or Brian on 087 2913186.

Services of Intercession for the Dead will take place in various cemeteries within our parish pastoral area as follows.
We take this opportunity to thank people for their ongoing commitment in remembering their loved ones by visiting and maintaining their graves.

St Patrick's Church, Murlog - Friday 8th May at 6.30 pm
St Joseph's Church, Glenmornan - Saturday 9th May at 6.00 pm
Strabane Cemetery & Camus - Sunday 10th May at 2.00 pm
Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road - Sunday 10th May at 4.30 pm
St Mary's Church, Cloughcor - Sunday 10th May at 6.30 pm

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: 4.30 pm; Sunday: 11.00 am

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: 12.15 pm

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: 6.30 pm; Sunday: 9.45 am

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: 8.30 am (26th April - alternate Sundays)

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: 8.30 am (3rd May - alternate Sundays)

Weekday Mass Schedule (Weekday Mass times will be reviewed at the end of April.)

Monday:	10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford
	12.00 noon: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road
Tuesday:	10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane
Wednesday:	10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford
	12.00 noon: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road
Thursday:	10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane
Friday:	7.45 am: Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road
	10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, **27 Butcher St, Strabane** covers all 3 parishes**.** **Office hours:** Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am - 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am - 12.30 pm. Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101,Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.